

January

9

1768

Roll up, roll up!

The world's first modern circus opened in London, UK, organized by horse rider Philip Astley. The show began with tricks on horseback around the circus ring and grew to include acrobats and jugglers.



Also on this day

1918 **The Battle of Bear Valley**, a clash between a band of Yaqui people and US Army soldiers, marked the final conflict of the American Frontier Wars.

1960 **The foundation stone** was laid in the construction of Aswan High Dam – the world's largest embankment dam – across the Nile River in Egypt.

1992 **The first exoplanets** – planets orbiting stars beyond the Solar System – were found by two astronomers, Aleksander Wolszczan of Poland and Dale Frail of Canada.

2007

First iPhone

US entrepreneur Steve Jobs presented the first iPhone to the public. With a camera and internet browser built in, this mobile phone was called the “invention of the year” by *Time* magazine.



Born this day

1908 Simone de Beauvoir, French thinker, writer, and women's rights advocate. In her books, she argued that women should have the same opportunities as men.

1816

Safety lamp

British chemist Sir Humphry Davy trialled his new safety lamp featuring an enclosed flame to protect miners. Previous lamps had open flames, which triggered explosions with the flammable gases in coal mines.

